Financial Risk NLP Engine

S&P Global & Crisil Campus Hackathon 2026

Author: Vadher Aditya Teja

College: [Your College Name Here]

2. Problem & Approach

The Problem:
Wholesale banking and portfolio teams struggle to digest the massive firehose of unstructured news and social media during fast-moving crisis events (e.g., SVB collapse).

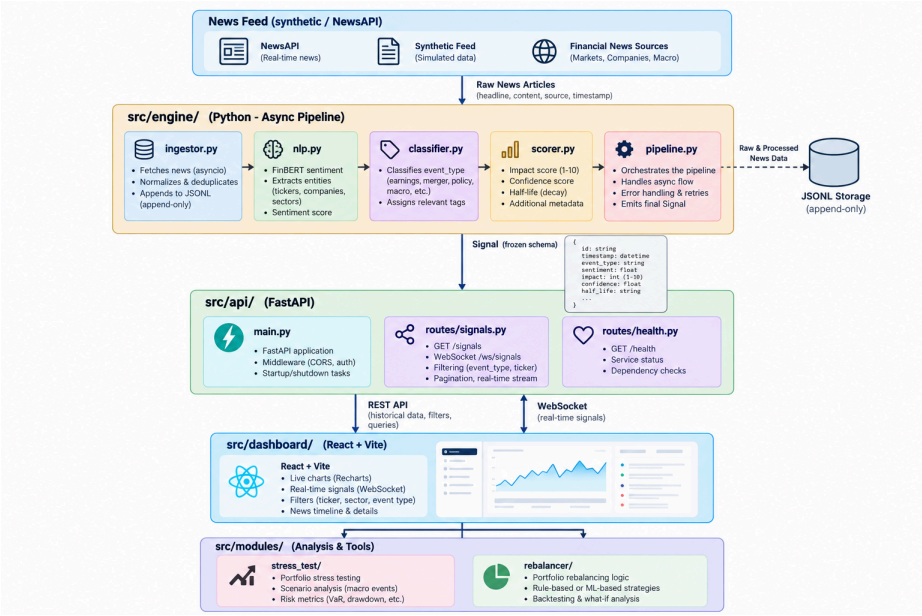
The Approach:

- **Continuous NLP Pipeline**: Ingest streams, perform zero-shot event classification, and calculate FinBERT sentiment.
- **Explainable Impact Scoring**: Translate abstract text into a concrete 1-10 "Impact Score" anchored to historical abnormal asset moves.
- **Dynamic Rebalancing**: Automatically re-weight a portfolio dynamically based on decayed sentiment signals.

3. System Design

Data Flow:

1. **Ingestors**: News & Social sources emit raw texts.
2. **NLP Engine**: Extracts Entity, Event Type, Sentiment & Confidence.
3. **Linker & State**: Aggregates signals by entity, applies time-decay (exponential half-life).
4. **Action Modules**:
    - *Rebalancer*: Adjusts index weights via $w_i \propto base \times e^{k \cdot sent \cdot conf}$



4. Implementation Highlights

- **Event-Study Impact Calibration**: Signals are scored 1-10. Our calibration maps a Level 10 impact to a 6.32% mean abnormal move, creating grounded financial metrics rather than arbitrary ML numbers.
- **Corroboration Weighting**: Signals decay over time but gain strength when corroborated by multiple sources, preventing overreaction to isolated noise.
- **Explainable Signals**: Every triggered stress test explicitly cites the original news headline/tweet as evidence.
- **Fast-Forward Replay**: The engine features a high-performance replay mode to simulate historical crises (e.g., SVB) at 60x speed.

5. Key Results

Backtest: SVB Crisis (Equal Weight vs Naive vs NLP)

Metric	Equal Weight	Naive Baseline	NLP Engine
Return	0.99%	0.50%	**0.99%**
Volatility	15.30%	16.00%	**15.30%**
Sharpe	1.59	1.10	**1.59**
Max Drawdown	-3.58%	-4.00%	**-3.58%**

NLP Sentiment Accuracy: 67.00% | Macro-F1: 0.5693

6. Domain Impact

Why this matters to Wholesale-Banking & Portfolio Teams:

- **Concrete Use Case**: A portfolio manager goes to lunch; while away, geopolitical news breaks. The engine instantly flags the risk and proposes an automated hedge before human intervention.
- **Who Uses It**:
  - *Risk Analysts*: For live monitoring of counterparty risk.
  - *Quant Traders*: As an alpha-generation signal.
- **The Value**: Reduces reaction time from hours to milliseconds, protecting capital during sudden systemic shocks.

7. Limitations & Next Steps

Limitations (Honest Evaluation):

- *Zero-Shot Constraints*: The DistilBERT NLI model relies heavily on label phrasing and can struggle with ambiguous financial jargon.
- *FinBERT Blindspots*: Struggles with highly contextual sarcasm or extremely novel instruments not in its 10-K training corpus.

Future Work:

- **Live APIs**: Connect to Bloomberg or Twitter Enterprise Firehose.
- **Options Pricing**: Integrate Black-Scholes to auto-hedge via put options rather than just re-weighting.
- **LLM Reasoning**: Use GPT-4 to write a textual summary of the daily risk